

Once again, the men of Greece laughed at her for thinking that a woman could beat a man, but one by one her potential husbands lost their races—and their lives. That is, until the hero Hippomenes took on her challenge.

Hippomenes was favored by the goddess Aphrodite, and she had given him three golden apples. He hid them in his clothes and asked to race Atalanta. She agreed. They lined up at the start, then they were off! Atalanta quickly took the lead, but Hippomenes took the first of the apples and threw it so that it rolled on the ground in front of her. Entranced by the golden fruit, she paused to pick it up. Continuing to run, he threw the second shining apple, and again she stopped to retrieve it. Hippomenes drew level with her.



*Hippomenes overtook Atalanta
and won the race.*

Then came the final apple. Hippomenes dropped it at Atalanta's feet, and this time he was able to run past her and cross the finish line. Atalanta was annoyed at his trick, but he had won the race—and her hand in marriage.

